

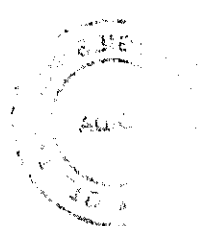
みんなの日本語
初級Ⅰ 第2版

Minna no Nihongo

Romanized Version

Elementary Japanese I Second Edition
Translation & Grammar Notes—English

翻訳・文法解説
ローマ字版【英語】



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FOREWORD

As the title *Minna no Nihongo* indicates, this book has been designed to make the study of Japanese as enjoyable and interesting as possible for students and teachers alike. Over three years in the planning and compilation, it stands as a complete textbook in itself while acting as a companion volume to the highly-regarded *Shin Nihongo no Kiso*.

As readers may know, *Shin Nihongo no Kiso* is a comprehensive introduction to elementary Japanese that serves as a highly efficient resource enabling students wishing to master basic Japanese conversation to do so in the shortest possible time. As such, although it was originally developed for use by AOTS's technical trainees, it is now used by a wide range of people both in Japan and abroad.

The teaching of Japanese is branching out in many different ways. Japanese economic and industrial growth has led to a greater level of interchange between Japan and other countries, and non-Japanese from a wide variety of backgrounds have come to Japan with a range of different objectives and are now living within local communities here. The changes in the social milieu surrounding the teaching of Japanese that have resulted from this influx of people from other countries have in turn influenced the individual situations in which Japanese is taught. There is now a greater diversity of learning needs, and they require individual responses.

It is against this background, and in response to the opinions and hopes expressed by a large number of people who have been involved in the teaching of Japanese for many years both in Japan and elsewhere, that 3A Corporation proudly publishes *Minna no Nihongo*. While the book continues to make use of the clarity and ease of understanding provided by the special features, key learning points and learning methods of *Shin Nihongo no Kiso*, the scenes, situations and characters in *Minna no Nihongo* have been made more universal in order to appeal to a wider range of learners. Its contents have been enhanced in this way to allow all kinds of students to use it for studying Japanese with pleasure.

Minna no Nihongo is aimed at anyone who urgently needs to learn to communicate in Japanese in any situation, whether at work, school, college or in their local community. Although it is an introductory text, efforts have been made to make the exchanges between Japanese and foreign characters in the book reflect Japanese social conditions and everyday life as faithfully as possible. While it is intended principally for those who have already left full-time education, it can also be recommended as an excellent textbook for university entrance courses as well as for short-term intensive courses at technical colleges and universities.

We at 3A Corporation are continuing actively to produce new study materials designed to meet the individual needs of an increasingly wide range of learners, and we sincerely hope that readers will continue to give us their valued support.

In conclusion, I should like to mention the extensive help we received in the preparation of this text, in the form of suggestions and comments from various quarters, and trials of the materials in actual lessons, for which we are extremely grateful. 3A Corporation intends to continue extending its network of friendship all over the world through activities such as the publishing of Japanese study materials, and we hope that everyone who knows us will continue to lend us their unstinting encouragement and support in this.

Iwao Ogawa
President, 3A Corporation
March 1998

FOREWORD TO THE SECOND EDITION

— On the Publication of the Second Edition of *Minna no Nihongo Shokyu* —

We are proud to publish the second edition of *Minna no Nihongo Shokyu*. As stated in the Foreword to the first edition, *Minna no Nihongo Shokyu* can be regarded as a companion volume to *Shin Nihongo no Kiso*, a textbook originally developed for technical trainees.

The first printing of the first edition of *Minna no Nihongo Shokyu I* was issued in March 1998, when great changes in the social environment surrounding the teaching of Japanese were taking place. The burgeoning of relationships between Japan and the rest of the world had led to a rapid increase in the number of students of Japanese and their reasons for studying the language, and the consequent diversification of their requirements had necessitated a response more tailored to learners' individual situations. 3A Corporation published *Minna no Nihongo Shokyu* in response to suggestions and comments received from people on the front lines of Japanese teaching in Japan and elsewhere.

Minna no Nihongo Shokyu was acclaimed for its easily-understood key learning points and methods, its high degree of general applicability that took into account learners' diversity, and for being a carefully-crafted learning resource that was outstandingly effective for students attempting to master Japanese conversation quickly. It has served well for over ten years, but any language changes with the times, and both Japan and other countries have experienced great upheavals recently. Particularly in the last few years, the environment in which the Japanese language and its learners are situated has changed drastically.

In these circumstances, 3A Corporation decided to review and partially revise *Minna no Nihongo Shokyu I* and *II*, based on our publishing and training experience and reflecting the many opinions and questions we have received from students and teachers of Japanese, in order to be able to contribute further to the teaching of Japanese as a foreign language.

The revision focused on making the book even more usable and changing any words or scenarios that no longer reflected current conditions. Respecting the wishes of students and teachers, we have preserved the original textbook format, which has the benefit of making the book easy to use for both learning and teaching, and we have introduced more exercises and practice questions designed to strengthen students' active language ability by inviting them to understand situations for themselves and think about how to express themselves, rather than merely following instructions and practising in a passive way. We have included a large number of illustrations for this purpose.

We are extremely grateful for the enormous help we received in the editing of this book, in the form of comments and suggestions from various quarters, and trials in actual lessons. 3A Corporation intends to continue developing textbooks that can not only help students of Japanese to communicate what they need to but also contribute to international interpersonal interchange, and we hope that everyone engaged in such activities will find them useful. We warmly invite everyone who knows us to continue to lend us their unstinting encouragement and support in this.

Takuji Kobayashi
President, 3A Corporation
June 2012

TO USERS OF THIS BOOK

I. Structure

The second edition of *Minna no Nihongo Shokyu I* consists of two volumes: the Main Text (with CD) and the Translation and Grammar Notes. We plan to publish the Translation and Grammar Notes in twelve languages, starting with English.

The materials have been compiled with the aim of inculcating the four skills of speaking, listening, reading and writing. However the Main Text and the Translation and Grammar Notes do not provide any instruction in reading and writing hiragana, katakana, or kanji.

II. Contents

1. Main Text

1) Japanese Pronunciation

This section gives examples of the chief points to note concerning Japanese pronunciation.

2) Classroom Language, Everyday Greetings and Expressions, Numerals

This section contains a list of words and phrases used in the classroom, basic everyday greetings, and so on.

3) Lessons

There are 25 lessons, each containing the following:

① Sentence patterns

Basic sentence patterns to be learned in that lesson.

② Example sentences

Basic sentence patterns incorporated into short dialogues to show how they are used in actual conversation. New adverbs, conjunctions, and other parts of speech, plus further learning points, are also introduced.

③ Conversation

In the conversation, foreign people living in Japan appear in a variety of situations. The conversation includes everyday greetings and other expressions and as well as the material to be learned in the lesson. If time allows, students can try developing the conversation by introducing some of the Useful Words given in the Translation and Grammar Notes.

④ Exercises

The exercises are split into three levels: A, B, and C.

Exercise A is laid out visually to help students understand the grammatical structure easily. It has been designed to make it easy for students to practise

conjugating verbs and forming connections, as well as mastering the basic sentence patterns.

Exercise B employs various forms to strengthen students' grasp of the basic sentence patterns. A number with an arrow () indicates an exercise that uses an illustration.

Exercise C is designed to help students improve their communication abilities. Students use this exercise to practise conversing while substituting the underlined words in the designated conversation with alternatives matching the situation; however, to prevent this becoming a simple substitution drill, we have wherever possible avoided using words to indicate substitutions. This means that the exercises are very free, with students able to create various different conversational examples based on a single illustration.

Model answers to Exercises B and C are available in a separate compilation volume.

⑤ Practice questions

There are three types of practice question: listening comprehension, grammar, and reading comprehension. The listening comprehension questions are further subdivided into two types: answering short questions, and listening to short conversations and grasping the key points. The grammar questions check students' understanding of vocabulary and grammar points. For the reading comprehension questions, students read a simple passage incorporating vocabulary and grammar they have already studied, and perform various types of task relating to its contents.

⑥ Review

This is provided to enable students to go over the essential points once more every few lessons.

⑦ Summary of Adverbs, Conjunctions and Conversational Expressions

These are practice questions designed to enable students to review the adverbs, conjunctions and conversational expressions presented in this textbook.

4) Verb forms

This section summarises the verb forms presented in this textbook, together with various forms added to the ends of verbs.

5) Table of Key Learning Points

This is a summary of the key learning points presented in this textbook, focusing on Exercise A. It is intended to enable students to understand the Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences and how they relate to Exercises B and C.

6) Index

This includes Classroom Language, Everyday Greetings and Expressions, and

new vocabulary and expressions appearing in each lesson, with references to the lesson in which they first appear.

7) Included CD

The CD that goes with this book contains the conversation and the listening comprehension exercises from each lesson.

2. Translation and Grammar notes

- 1) Explanations of the general features of Japanese, as well as the Japanese writing and pronunciation systems.
- 2) Translations of Classroom Language, and Everyday Greetings and Expressions.
- 3) The following for each of Lessons 1 through 25:
 - ① New words and their translations.
 - ② Translations of Sentence Patterns, Example Sentences and Conversations.
 - ③ Useful words relevant to each lesson and snippets of information on Japan.
 - ④ Explanations of the grammar of the Sentence Patterns and expressions.
- 4) A summary of how to express numbers, time, and time periods, a list of counter suffixes, and conjugations of verbs.

III. Time Required to Complete the Lessons

As a guideline, it should take students 4-6 hours to cover each lesson, and 150 hours to finish the entire book.

IV. Vocabulary

The book presents approximately 1,000 words, mainly ones used frequently in daily life.

V. Romanization

- 1) In general, the Hepburn system of romanization has been used.
The syllabic nasal sound is represented by 'n' throughout.
- 2) Long vowels are indicated as follows:
ā, ii, ū, ei (ē), ō
e.g. okāsan (mother) ōkii (big, large) tokei (watch, clock)
onēsan (elder sister)
- 3) For readability, the text has been transliterated with spaces between words.
Particles are written separately except when accepted as forming a single unit with the parent word.
e.g. nanika (something) desukara (therefore, so)

- 4) Prefixes, suffixes and counters are usually separated from their parent words by hyphens, and long compound words are broken up by hyphens.

e.g. o-shigoto (work, business) Tanaka-san (Mr. Tanaka)

25-sai (25 years old) hana-ya (florist) benkyō-shimasu (study)

However, the hyphen is omitted when the compound is regarded as a single unit.

e.g. hitotsu (one) hitori (one person) ocha (tea) asagohan (breakfast)

oyasuminasai (good night)

- 5) Capitals are used at the beginning of sentences and for the initial letters of proper nouns.

- 6) Foreign names are spelt according to the katakana spelling.

e.g. Mirā-san (Mr. Miller)

- 7) Some foreign loan words are romanized to approximate their original pronunciation.

e.g. pātii (party) fōku (fork)

VI. Miscellaneous

- 1) Words that can be omitted are enclosed in square brackets:

e.g. Chichi wa 54 [-sai] desu. (My father is 54 [years old]).

- 2) Synonymous words and expressions are enclosed in round brackets:

e.g. dare (donata) (who)

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK EFFECTIVELY

1. Learn the words

The Translation and Grammar Notes introduces the new words for each lesson. Learn these new words by practising making short sentences with them.

2. Practise the Sentence Patterns

Make sure you understand the meaning of each sentence pattern, and do Exercises A and B aloud until the pattern becomes automatic.

3. Practise holding conversations

Practise the sentence patterns using the short dialogues given in Exercise C, but don't stop there; carry on and extend the conversations. The conversations simulate everyday situations that students are likely to encounter, and the best way of acquiring a natural conversational rhythm is to act out the conversations using gestures and facial expressions while listening to the CD.

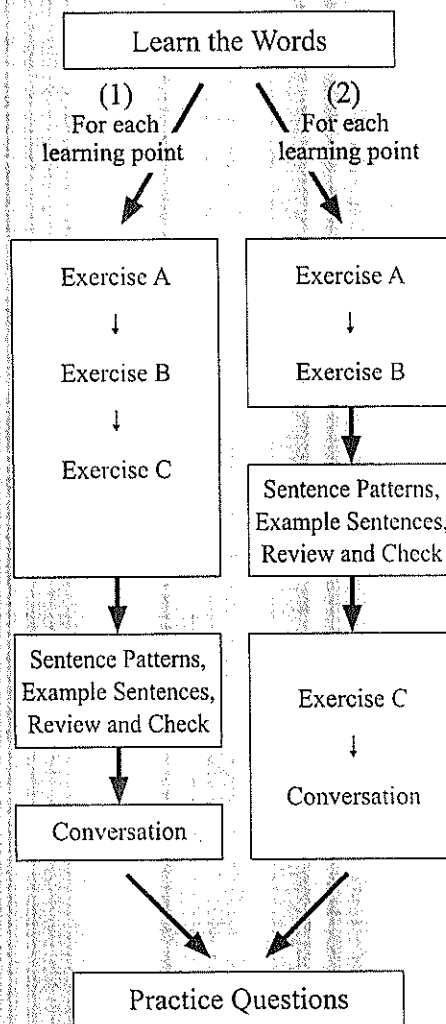
4. Check your understanding

Each lesson ends with some practice questions which you should use to check that you have correctly understood the lesson.

5. Apply what you have learnt

Try talking to Japanese people using the Japanese you have learnt. Applying what you have learnt right away, before you forget it, is the quickest way to progress.

Learning Sequence for Each Lesson



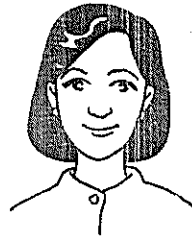
Study the material by following either Route (1) or Route (2). To make sure you cover all the key learning points, please check the Table of Key Learning Points at the end of this book.

CHARACTERS



Mike Miller

American, employee of IMC



Sato Keiko

Japanese, employee of IMC



Jose Santos

Brazilian, employee of Brazil Air



Maria Santos

Brazilian, housewife



Karina

Indonesian, student at Fuji University



Wang Xue

Chinese, doctor at Kobe Hospital



Yamada Ichiro

Japanese, employee of IMC



Yamada Tomoko

Japanese, bank clerk



Matsumoto Tadashi

Japanese,
department chief at IMC



Matsumoto Yoshiko

Japanese, housewife



Kimura Izumi

Japanese, announcer



Karl Schmidt

German,
engineer at Power Electric Company



John Watt

British,
professor at Sakura University



Lee Jin Ju

Korean,
research worker at AKC



Teresa Santos

Brazilian, schoolgirl (9 yrs.),
daughter of Jose and Maria Santos



Yamada Taro

Japanese, schoolboy (8 yrs.),
son of Ichiro and Tomoko Yamada



Gupta

Indian, employee of IMC



Thawaphon

Thai,
student at Japanese language school

※ IMC (computer software company)

※ AKC (Aija-kenkyū-sentā : Asia Research Institute)

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Lesson 1 10

I . Vocabulary	IV . Grammar Notes
II . Translation	1. N ₁ wa N ₂ desu
Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences	2. N ₁ wa N ₂ ja (dewa) arimasen
Conversation: How do you do?	3. N ₁ wa N ₂ desu ka
III . Useful Words and Information	4. N mo
Countries, People and	5. N ₁ no N ₂
Languages	6. -san

Lesson 2 16

I . Vocabulary	IV . Grammar Notes
II . Translation	1. kore/sore/are
Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences	2. kono N/sono N/ano N
Conversation:	3. sō desu
Thank you in advance for your	4. ~ ka, ~ ka
kindness	5. N ₁ no N ₂
III . Useful Words and Information	6. no substituting for a noun
Family Names	7. o-
	8. sō desu ka

Lesson 3 22

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation: **I'll take it, please**

III . Useful Words and Information

Department Store

IV . Grammar Notes

1. koko/soko/asoko/kochira/sochira/
achira
2. N wa place desu
3. doko/dochira
4. N₁ no N₂
5. The ko/so/a/do
system of demonstratives
6. o-

Lesson 4 28

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation:

What time are you open to?

III . Useful Words and Information

Telephone and Letters

IV . Grammar Notes

1. Ima -ji -fun desu
2. V-masu/V-masen/V-mashita/
V-masendeshita
3. N (time) ni V
4. N₁ kara N₂ made
5. N₁ to N₂
6. ~ ne

Lesson 5 34

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation:

Does this train go to Koshien?

III . Useful Words and Information

National Holidays

IV . Grammar Notes

1. N (place) e ikimasu/kimasu/
kaerimasu
2. Doko [e] mo ikimasen/
ikimasendeshita
3. N (vehicle) de ikimasu/kimasu/
kaerimasu
4. N (person/animal) to V
5. itsu
6. ~ yo
7. sô desu ne

Lesson 6 40

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation:

Shall we go together?

III . Useful Words and Information

Food

IV . Grammar Notes

1. N o V (transitive)
2. N o shimasu
3. Nani o shimasu ka
4. nan and nani
5. N (place) de V
6. V-masen ka
7. V-mashō
8. ~ ka

Lesson 7 46

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation: **Welcome**

III . Useful Words and Information

Family

IV . Grammar Notes

1. N (tool/means) de V
2. 'Word/Sentence' wa -go de
nan desu ka
3. N₁ (person) ni N₂ o agemasu, etc.
4. N₁ (person) ni N₂ o moraimasu, etc.
5. Mō V-mashita
6. Omission of particles

Lesson 8 52

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation:

It's time we were going

III . Useful Words and Information

Colours and Tastes

IV . Grammar Notes

1. Adjectives
2. N wa na-adj [ná] desu
N wa i-adj (~i) desu
3. na-adj na N
i-adj (~i) N
4. ~ ga, ~
5. totemo/amari
6. N wa dō desu ka
7. N₁ wa donna N₂ desu ka
8. sō desu ne

Lesson 9 58

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation: **It's a pity.....**

III . Useful Words and Information

Music, Sports and Films

IV . Grammar Notes

1. N ga arimasu/wakarimasu
N ga suki desu/kirai desu/
jōzu desu/heta desu
2. donna N
3. yoku/daitai/takusan/sukoshi/
amari/zenzen
4. ~ kara, ~
5. dōshite

Lesson 10 64

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation:

Do you have any nam pla?

III . Useful Words and Information

Inside the House

IV . Grammar Notes

1. N ga arimasu/imasu
2. Place ni N ga arimasu/imasu
3. N wa place ni arimasu/imasu
4. N₁ (thing/person/place) no N₂ (position)
5. N₁ ya N₂
6. Ajia-sutoa desu ka

Lesson 11 70

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation:

[I'd like to send] this, please

III . Useful Words and Information

Menu

IV . Grammar Notes

1. How to say numbers
2. How to use quantifiers
3. Quantifier (time period) ni -kai V
4. Quantifier dake/N dake

Lesson 12 76

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation:

How was the Gion Festival?

III . Useful Words and Information

Festivals and Places of Note

IV . Grammar Notes

1. Tense and affirmative/negative
forms of noun sentences and
na-adjective sentences
2. Tense and affirmative/negative
forms of i-adjective sentences
3. N₁ wa N₂ yori adj desu
4. N₁ to N₂ to dochira ga adj desu ka
.....N₁/N₂ no hō ga adj desu
5. N₁ [no naka] de nani/doko/dare/itsu
ga ichiban adj desu ka
.....N₂ ga ichiban adj desu
6. Adj no (no substituting for a noun)

Lesson 13 82

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation: **Separately, please**

III . Useful Words and Information

Town

IV . Grammar Notes

1. N ga hoshii desu

2. V masu-form tai desu

3. N (place) e { V masu-form } ni

ikimasu/kimasu/kaerimasu

4. dokoka/nanika

5. go-

Lesson 14 88

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation: **To Midoricho, please**

III . Useful Words and Information

Station

IV . Grammar Notes

1. Verb Groups

2. V te-form

3. V te-form kudasai

4. V te-form imasu

5. V masu-form mashō ka

6. N ga V

7. sumimasen ga

Lesson 15 94

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation:

What family do you have?

III . Useful Words and Information

Occupations

IV . Grammar Notes

1. V te-form mo ii desu ka

2. V te-form wa ikemasen

3. V te-form imasu

4. N ni V

5. N₁ ni N₂ o V

Lesson 16 100

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation:

Please show me how to use it

III . Useful Words and Information

How to Use a Cash Machine

IV . Grammar Notes

1. How to join two or more sentences together

2. V₁ te-form kara, V₂

3. N₁ wa N₂ ga adj

4. N o V

5. dōyatte

6. dore/dono N

Lesson 17 106

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation:

What seems to be the matter?

III . Useful Words and Information

Body and Illness

IV . Grammar Notes

1. V nai-form
2. V nai-form nai de kudasai
3. V nai-form nakereba narimasen
4. V nai-form nakute mo ii desu
5. Making an object the topic of a sentence
6. N (time) made ni V

Lesson 18 112

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation:

What do you like doing?

III . Useful Words and Information

Actions

IV . Grammar Notes

1. Dictionary form of verbs
2. N
V-dictionary form koto } ga
dekimasu
3. Watashi no shumi wa
N
V-dictionary form koto } desu
4. V₁-dictionary form
N no
Quantifier (time period) } mae ni, V₂
5. nakanaka
6. zehi

Lesson 19 118

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation:

I'll start dieting tomorrow

III . Useful Words and Information

**Traditional Culture and
Entertainment**

IV . Grammar Notes

1. V ta-form
2. V ta-form koto ga arimasu
3. V₁ ta-form ri, V₂ ta-form ri
shimasu
4. i-adj (〜い) → ~ku
na-adj [〜な] → ~ni
N ni } narimasu

Lesson 20 124

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation: **Shall we go together?**

III . Useful Words and Information

How to Address People

IV . Grammar Notes

1. Polite style and plain style
2. Proper use of the polite style or plain style
3. Conversation in the plain style

Lesson 21 130

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation: **I think so, too**

III . Useful Words and Information

Positions in Society

IV . Grammar Notes

1. Plain form to omoimasu

2. "Sentences" } to iimasu
Plain form }

3. V } plain form }
i-adj } }
na-adj } plain form } deshō ?
N } ~ da }

4. N₁ (place) de N₂ ga arimasu

5. N (occasion) de

6. N demo V

7. V nai-form nai to.....

Lesson 22 136

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation:

**What kind of flat are you
looking for?**

III . Useful Words and Information

Clothes

IV . Grammar Notes

1. Noun modification

2. V-dictionary form

jikan/yakusoku/yōji

3. V masu-form mashō ka

Lesson 23 142

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation:

How do you get there?

III . Useful Words and Information

Roads and Traffic

IV . Grammar Notes

1. V-dictionary form }
V nai-form nai }
i-adj (~i) } toki, ~ (main clause)
na-adj na }
N no }

2. V-dictionary form }
V ta-form } toki, ~ (main clause)

3. V-dictionary form to, ~ (main clause)

4. N ga adj

5. N o motionV

Lesson 24 148

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation:

Shall I come and help?

III . Useful Words and Information

Exchanging Gifts

IV . Grammar Notes

1. kuremasu

2.

V te-form	{	agemasu
		moraimasu
		kuremasu

3. N₁ wa N₂ ga V

Lesson 25 154

I . Vocabulary

II . Translation

Sentence Patterns and Example Sentences

Conversation:

Thanks for everything

III . Useful Words and Information

Life

IV . Grammar Notes

1. Plain past form ra, ~ (main clause)

2. V ta-form ra, ~ (main clause)

3. V te-form

V nai-form nakute	}	mo, ~ (main clause)
i-adj (~い) → ~kute		
na-adj [ない] → ~de		
N de		

4. moshi

5. Subject of a subordinate clause

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II . Expressions of time 165

III . Expressions of period 167

IV . Counter suffixes 168

V . Conjugations of verbs 170

GENERAL FEATURES OF JAPANESE

1. **Parts of Speech** The Japanese language is composed of verbs, adjectives, nouns, adverbs, conjunctions, particles and other parts of speech.
2. **Word Order** In Japanese, predicates always come at the end of a sentence. Modifiers always appear in front of the word(s) modified.
3. **Predicates** Predicates are formed from verbs, adjectives, nouns and desu (da). They inflect according to, for example, whether they are (1) affirmative or negative, (2) past or non-past. They do not inflect for person, gender or number.
4. **Particles** Particles are used after a word or at the end of a sentence. They indicate relationships between words and add various meanings.
5. **Omission** Subjects and objects are often omitted if they can be understood from the context.

JAPANESE WRITING

2

There are three types of script in Japanese: hiragana, katakana, and kanji (Chinese characters).

Hiragana and katakana are phonetic symbols purely representing sounds, while kanji are ideographs, conveying meanings as well as sounds.

Japanese is usually written with a combination of hiragana, katakana, and kanji, with katakana used to write foreign names and loanwords and hiragana used to write particles and the grammatical endings of verbs and adjectives.

Romaji (the letters of the Roman alphabet) are also occasionally used to write Japanese (the names of train stations are one example) for the convenience of foreigners.

Here are examples of all four types of script:

田中 さん は ミラー さん と デパート へ 行 きます。
○ □ □ △ □ □ △ □ ○ □

Mr. Tanaka is going to the department store with Mr. Miller.

大阪 Osaka

○ ☆

(○- kanji □- hiragana △- katakana ☆- romaji)

INTRODUCTION

1. Japanese Pronunciation

1. Kana and Mora

Japanese can be written phonetically in kana as shown below.

A 'mora' is a unit of sound equivalent in length to one Japanese kana (or two of the contracted sounds called yo-on, which are written with small kana).

The Japanese language is based on five vowel sounds: a, i, u, e and o, which are used alone or attached to either a consonant (e.g. k + a = ka) or to a consonant plus the semi-vowel 'y' (e.g. k + y + a = kya) (the only exception being a special mora, n, which is not followed by a vowel). All of these sounds are or more or less equal in length when spoken.

	a-column	i-column	u-column	e-column	o-column
a-row	あ ア a	い イ i	う ウ u	え エ e	お オ o
ka-row k	か カ ka	き キ ki	く ク ku	け ケ ke	こ コ ko
sa-row s	さ サ sa	し シ shi	す ス su	せ セ se	そ ソ so
ta-row t	た タ ta	ち チ chi	つ ツ tsu	て テ te	と ト to
na-row n	な ナ na	に ニ ni	ぬ ヌ nu	ね ネ ne	の ノ no
ha-row h	は ハ ha	ひ ヒ hi	ふ フ fu	へ ヘ he	ほ ホ ho
ma-row m	ま マ ma	み ミ mi	む ム mu	め メ me	も モ mo
ya-row y	や ヤ ya	(いイ) (i)	ゆ ユ yu	(えエ) (e)	よ ヨ yo
ra-row r	ら ラ ra	り リ ri	る ル ru	れ レ re	ろ ロ ro
wa-row w	わ ワ wa	(いイ) (i)	(うウ) (u)	(えエ) (e)	を ヲ o
	ん ン n				

e.g.,

 hiragana
 katakana
 romaji

きゃ キャ kya	きゅ キュ kyu	きょ キョ kyo
しゃ シャ sha	しゅ シュ shu	しょ ショ sho
ちゃ チャ cha	ちゅ チュ chu	ちょ チョ cho
にゃ ニャ nya	にゅ ニュ nyu	にょ ニョ nyo
ひゃ ヒャ hya	ひゅ ヒュ hyu	ひょ ヒョ hyo
みゃ ミャ mya	みゅ ミュ myu	みょ ミョ myo

りゃ リャ rya	りゅ リュ ryu	りょ リョ ryo
--------------	--------------	--------------

ga-row g	が ガ ga	ぎ ギ gi	ぐ グ gu	げ ゲ ge	ご ゴ go
za-row z	ざ ザ za	じ ジ ji	ず ズ zu	ぜ ゼ ze	ぞ ゾ zo
da-row d	だ ダ da	ぢ チ ji	づ ツ zu	で デ de	ど ド do
ba-row b	ば バ ba	び ビ bi	ぶ ブ bu	べ ベ be	ぼ ボ bo
pa-row p	ぱ パ pa	ぴ ピ pi	ぷ プ pu	ぺ ペ pe	ぽ ポ po

ぎゃ ギャ gya	ぎゅ ギュ gyu	ぎょ ギョ gyo
じゃ ジャ ja	じゅ ジュ ju	じょ ジョ jo

びゃ ビャ bya	びゅ ビュ byu	びょ ビョ byo
ぴゃ ピャ pya	ぴゅ ピュ pyu	ぴょ ピョ pyo

The katakana letters in the square on the right are not in the above table. They are used to write sounds which are not original Japanese sounds but are needed for use in loanwords.

ウィ wi	ウェ we	ウォ wo
ツァ tsa	シェ she	ツェ tse
ファ fa	チェ che	ツォ tso
ティ ti	フェ fe	フォ fo
フィ fi	ジェ je	
ディ di	ドゥ du	
	デュ dyu	

2. Long vowels

The five vowel sounds mentioned earlier (a, i, u, e and o) constitute short vowels in Japanese, but they can be doubled in length (to two moras) to form long vowels. The meaning of a word changes according to the length of its vowel(s).

e.g. obasan (aunt) : obāsan (grandmother)
ojisan (uncle) : ojiisan (grandfather)
yuki (snow) : yūki (courage)
e (picture) : ē (yes)
toru (take) : tōru (pass)
koko (here) : kōkō (high school)
heya (room) : heiya (plain)
kādo (card) takushii (taxi) sūpā (supermarket)
esukarētā (escalator) nōto (notebook)

[Note]

How to write long vowels in rōmaji:

In romanized transcription (rōmaji), a long vowel is marked by a bar above the letter as shown below, except for the long vowels of i and e which are written as ii and ei.

Short vowel: a i u e o

Long vowel: ā ii ū ei ō

* ē is used in some words such as:

ē (yes) nē (I say) onēsan (elder sister)

* ē is also used to write loan words:

kēki (cake)

3. Pronunciation of n

'n' is one mora long and never appears at the beginning of a word. To make it easier to say, it is pronounced /n/, /m/ or /ŋ/ according to the sound that comes after it.

① Before sounds from the 'ta-row', 'da-row', 'ra-row' and 'na-row',

it is pronounced /n/,

e.g. hantai (opposite) undō (sport) senro (track) minna (everyone).

② Before sounds from the 'ba-row', 'pa-row' and 'ma-row', it is pronounced /m/.

e.g. shinbun (newspaper) enpitsu (pencil) unmei (destiny).

③ Before sounds from the 'ka-row' and 'ga-row', it is pronounced /ŋ/.

e.g. tenki (weather) kengaku (study visit).

4. Double Consonants

Some consonants such as 'k', 's', 't' and 'p' occur as double consonants. In writing loan words, 'z' and 'd' also occur as double consonants.

- e.g. buka (subordinate) : bukka (commodity price)
kasai (fire) : kassai (applause)
oto (sound) : otto (husband)
nikki (diary) zasshi (magazine) kitte (stamp)
ippai (full) koppu (glass) beddo (bed)

5. Contracted Sound

The sound represented by using one of the small kana letters 'ゃ/ya', 'ゅ/yu' or 'ょ/yo' in combination with a full-sized kana letter is called a yo-on (contracted sound). Although written with two kana letters, these sounds are only one mora long.

- e.g. ひゃく hyaku (hundred) シャツ shatsu (shirt) おちゃ ocha (tea)
しゅみ shumi (hobby) うんてんしゅ untenshu (driver)
りょこう ryokō (travel) しやくしょ shiyakusho (city hall)

For Romanized transcription, see the table on the right on page 3.

6. Pronunciation of ga-row

5

The consonants of the ga-row pronounced [g] when they fall at the beginning of a word, and [ŋ] when they fall elsewhere. However, some people these days make no distinction between these two sounds and pronounce them [g] wherever they fall.

7. Devoicing of vowels

The vowels [i] and [u] tend to be devoiced and become silent when they fall between voiceless consonants (e.g. suki like). The final vowel [u] of '~ desu' and '-masu' also tends to be silent (e.g. shitai desu want to do, kikimasu listen).

8. Accent

The Japanese language has pitch accent; that is, some moras in a word are pronounced high and others low. There are four types of accent, and the meaning of a word changes according to how it is accented.

The standard Japanese accent is characterised by the fact that the first and second moras have different pitches, and that the pitch never rises again once it has fallen.

Types of accent

- ① Flat (the pitch does not drop)
e.g. niwa (garden) hana (nose) namae (name)
Nihon-go (Japanese language)
- ② Beginning high (the pitch drops after the first mora)
e.g. hon (book) tenki (weather) raigetsu (next month)
- ③ Middle high (the pitch drops after the second mora)
e.g. tamago (egg) hikōki [hikooki] (airplane) sensei (teacher)
- ④ Ending high (the pitch drops after the last mora)
e.g. kutsu (shoes) hana (flower) yasumi (holiday)
otōto (younger brother)

hana (nose) in ① and hana (flower) in ④ sound similar, but if the particle ga is added after these they are accented differently, and ① is pronounced hanaga while ④ is pronounced hanaga. Here are some other examples of words whose meaning differs according to the type of accent:

hashi (bridge) : hashi (chopsticks) ichi (one) : ichi (position)

There are also local differences in accent. For example, the accent in the Osaka area is quite different from the standard accent. Here are some examples:

e.g. Tokyo accent : Osaka accent
(standard Japanese accent)

hana : hana (flower)
ringo : ringo (apple)
ongaku : ongaku (music)

9. Intonation

There are three patterns of intonation in Japanese: ① flat ② rising, and ③ falling. Questions are pronounced with a rising intonation. Other sentences are usually pronounced flat, but sometimes with a falling intonation. A falling intonation can express feelings such as agreement, disappointment, etc.

e.g. Satō: Ashita tomodachi to o-hanami o shimasu. [→ flat]
Mirā-san mo issho ni ikimasen ka. [↗ rising]
Mirā: Ii desu ne. [↘ falling]
Sato: I'm going to see the cherry blossoms tomorrow with some friends.
Would you like to come with us, Mr. Miller?
Miller: That sounds good.

II. Classroom Language

1. Hajimemashō.	Let's begin.
2. Owarimashō.	Let's finish.
3. Yasumimashō.	Let's take a break.
4. Wakarimasu ka.	Do you understand?
……Hai, wakarimasu.	……Yes, I do./
lie, wakarimasen.	No, I don't.
5. Mō ichido [onegai-shimasu].	Once more [please].
6. Ii desu.	That's fine.
7. Chigaimasu.	No, that's wrong.
8. namae	name
9. shiken, shukudai	test, homework
10. shitsumon, kotae, rei	question, answer, example

III. Everyday Greetings and Expressions

1. Ohayō gozaimasu.	Good morning.
2. Konnichiwa.	Hello.
3. Konbanwa.	Good evening.
4. Oyasuminasai.	Good night.
5. Sayōnara.	Goodbye.
6. Arigatō gozaimasu.	Thank you.
7. Sumimasen.	Excuse me./Sorry.
8. Onegai-shimasu.	Please.

TERMS USED FOR INSTRUCTION

dai — ka	Lesson —	fōmu	form
bunkei	Sentence Pattern	-kei	~ form
reibun	Example Sentence	shūshoku	modification
kaiwa	Conversation	reigai	exception
renshū	Exercise		
mondai	Practice Question	meishi	noun
kotae	Answer	dōshi	verb
yomimono	Text	keiyōshi	adjective
fukushū	Review	i-keiyōshi	i-adjective
		na-keiyōshi	na-adjective
mokuji	Contents	joshi	particle
		fukushi	adverb
sakuin	Index	setsuzokushi	conjunction
		sūshi	numeral
bunpō	grammar	josūshi	counter suffix
bun	sentence	gimonshi	interrogative
tango (go)	word	meishi-bun	noun (predicate)
ku	phrase		sentence
setsu	clause	dōshi-bun	verb (predicate)
			sentence
hatsuon	pronunciation	keiyōshi-bun	adjective (predicate)
boin	vowel		sentence
shiin	consonant		
haku	mora	shugo	subject
akusento	accent	jutsugo	predicate
intonēshon	intonation	mokutekigo	object
		shudai	topic
[ka-]gyō	[ka-]row		
[i-]retsu	[i-]column	kōtei	affirmative
		hitei	negative
teinei-tai	polite style of speech	kanryō	perfective
futsū-tai	plain style of speech	mi-kanryō	imperfective
katsuyō	inflection, conjugation	kako	past
		hi-kako	non-past

KEY TO SYMBOLS AND ABBREVIATIONS

1. Symbols Used in I. Vocabulary

- ① ~ indicates a missing word or phrase
e.g. ~ kara kimashita. came from ~
- ② Words and phrases that can be omitted are enclosed in square brackets:
e.g. Dōzo yoroshiku [onagai-shimasu]. Pleased to meet you.
- ③ Synonymous words and phrases are enclosed in round brackets:
e.g. dare (donata) who
- ④ Words marked with a star (*) are not used in that lesson but are presented as being relevant.
- ⑤ The Exercise C section ((**Renshū C**)) presents expressions used in the lesson's Exercise C.
- ⑥ The Conversation section ((**Kaiwa**)) presents words and expressions used in the lesson's Conversation.

2. Abbreviations Used in IV. Grammar Notes

N	noun (meishi)	e.g. gakusei (student) tsukue (desk)
i-adj	i-adjective (i-keiyōshi)	e.g. oishii (delicious) takai (high, expensive)
na-adj	na-adjective (na-keiyōshi)	e.g. kirei[na] (beautiful) shizuka[na] (quiet)
V	verb (dōshi)	e.g. kakimasu (write) tabemasu (eat)
S	sentence (bun)	e.g. Kore wa hon desu. This is a book. Watashi wa ashita Tōkyō e ikimasu. I'm going to Tokyo tomorrow.

Lesson 1

I. Vocabulary

watashi	わたし	I
anata	あなた	you
ano hito (ano kata)	あの ひと (あの かた)	that person, he, she (ano kata is the polite equivalent of ano hito)
-san	～さん	Mr., Ms. (suffix added to a name for expressing politeness)
-chan	～ちゃん	(suffix often added to a child's name instead of -san)
-jin	～じん	(suffix meaning 'a national of'; e.g. Amerika-jin, an American)
sensei	せんせい	teacher, instructor (not used when referring to one's own job)
kyōshi	きょうし	teacher, instructor
gakusei	がくせい	student
kaishain	かいしゃいん	company employee
shain	しゃいん	employee of ~ company (used with company's name, e.g. IMC no shain)
ginkōin	ぎんこういん	bank employee
isha	いしゃ	[medical] doctor
kenkyūsha	けんきゅうしゃ	researcher, scholar
daigaku	だいがく	university
byōin	びょういん	hospital
dare (donata)	だれ (どなた)	who (donata is the polite equivalent of dare)
-sai	～さい	— years old
nan-sai (o-ikutsu)	なんさい (おいくつ)	how old (o-ikutsu is the polite equivalent of nan-sai)
hai	はい	yes
ie	いいえ	no

〈Renshū C〉

Hajimemashite.	はじめまして。	How do you do? (lit. I am meeting you for the first time. Usually used as the first phrase when introducing oneself.)
～ kara kimashita.	～から きました。	I'm from ～ (country).
[Dōzo] yoroshiku [onegai-shimasu].	[どうぞ] よろしく [おねがいします]。	Pleased to meet you. (lit. Please be nice to me. Usually used at the end of a self-introduction.)
shitsurei desu ga	しつれいですが	Excuse me, but (used when asking someone for personal information such as their name or address)
O-namae wa?	おなまえは?	May I have your name?
Kochira wa -san desu.	こちらは ～さんです。	This is Mr./Ms. ～.

Amerika	アメリカ	U.S.A.
Igirisu	イギリス	U.K.
Indo	インド	India
Indoneshia	インドネシア	Indonesia
Kankoku	かんこく	South Korea
Tai	タイ	Thailand
Chūgoku	ちゅうごく	China
Doitsu	ドイツ	Germany
Nihon	にほん	Japan
Burajiru	ブラジル	Brazil
IMC/Pawā-denki/ Burajiru-eā	IMC／パワーでんき／ ブラジルエアー	fictitious companies
AKC	AKC	a fictitious institute
Kōbe-byōin	こうべびょういん	a fictitious hospital
Sakura-daigaku/ Fuji-daigaku	さくらだいがく／ ふじだいがく	fictitious universities

II. Translation

Sentence Patterns

1. I'm Mike Miller.
2. Mr. Santos isn't a student.
3. Is Mr. Miller a company employee?
4. Mr. Santos is also a company employee.

Example Sentences

1. Are you [Mr.] Mike Miller?
.....Yes, I am [Mike Miller].
2. Are you a student, Mr. Miller?
.....No, I'm not [a student].
3. Is Mr. Wang a bank employee?
.....No, he isn't [a bank employee]. He's a doctor.
4. Who's that [person]?
.....That's Professor Watt. He's at Sakura University.
5. Is Mr. Gupta a company employee?
.....Yes, he is [a company employee].
Is Karina a company employee, too?
.....No, she's a student.
6. How old is Teresa?
.....She's nine [years old].

12

Conversation

How do you do?

- Sato: Good morning.
Yamada: Good morning.
Ms. Sato, this is Mike Miller.
Miller: How do you do?
I'm Mike Miller.
I'm from America.
Pleased to meet you.
Sato: I'm Keiko Sato.
Nice to meet you.

III. Useful Words and Information

KUNI • HITO • KOTOBA Countries, People and Languages

1

Kuni	Country	Hito	People	Kotoba	Language
Amerika	(U.S.A.)	Amerika-jin		Eigo	(English)
Igirisu	(U.K.)	Igirisu-jin		Eigo	(English)
Itaria	(Italy)	Itaria-jin		Itaria-go	(Italian)
Iran	(Iran)	Iran-jin		Perushia-go	(Persian)
Indo	(India)	Indo-jin		Hindii-go	(Hindi)
Indoneshia	(Indonesia)	Indoneshia-jin		Indoneshia-go	(Indonesian)
Ejiputo	(Egypt)	Ejiputo-jin		Arabia-go	(Arabic)
Ôsutoraria	(Australia)	Ôsutoraria-jin		Eigo	(English)
Kanada	(Canada)	Kanada-jin		Eigo	(English)
				Furansu-go	(French)
Kankoku	(South Korea)	Kankoku-jin		Kankoku-go	(Korean)
Saujiarabia	(Saudi Arabia)	Saujiarabia-jin		Arabia-go	(Arabic)
Shingapôru	(Singapore)	Shingapôru-jin		Eigo	(English)
Supein	(Spain)	Supein-jin		Supein-go	(Spanish)
Tai	(Thailand)	Tai-jin		Tai-go	(Thai)
Chûgoku	(China)	Chûgoku-jin		Chûgoku-go	(Chinese)
Doitsu	(Germany)	Doitsu-jin		Doitsu-go	(German)
Nihon	(Japan)	Nihon-jin		Nihon-go	(Japanese)
Furansu	(France)	Furansu-jin		Furansu-go	(French)
Firipin	(Philippines)	Firipin-jin		Firipino-go	(Filipino)
Burajiru	(Brazil)	Burajiru-jin		Porutogaru-go	(Portuguese)
Betonamu	(Vietnam)	Betonamu-jin		Betonamu-go	(Vietnamese)
Marêshia	(Malaysia)	Marêshia-jin		Marêshia-go	(Malaysian)
Mekishiko	(Mexico)	Mekishiko-jin		Supein-go	(Spanish)
Roshia	(Russia)	Roshia-jin		Roshia-go	(Russian)

IV. Grammar Notes

1. N_1 wa N_2 desu

1) Particle wa

The particle wa indicates that the noun before it (N_1) is the topic of the sentence (see Topic and Subject article). The speaker forms a sentence by adding wa to what he or she wants to talk about, and then makes statements about it.

① Watashi wa Maiku Mirā desu.

I'm Mike Miller.

2) Desu

Nouns used with desu work as predicates. Besides indicating judgment or assertion, desu also shows politeness towards the listener. Desu inflects when the sentence is negative (see 2. below) or in the past tense (see Lesson 12).

② Watashi wa kaishain desu.

I'm a company employee.

2. N_1 wa N_2 ja (dewa) arimasen

Ja (dewa) arimasen is the negative form of desu. Ja arimasen is often used in everyday conversation, while dewa arimasen is used in formal speech and writing.

③ Santosu-san wa gakusei ja arimasen. Mr. Santos isn't a student.
(dewa)

3. N_1 wa N_2 desu ka (question)

1) Particle ka

The particle ka is used to express uncertainty, doubt, etc. on the part of the speaker. A question can be formed simply by adding ka to the end of a sentence. A question usually ends with a rising intonation.

2) Questions asking whether a statement is correct or not

This type of question is formed simply by adding ka to the end of the statement, leaving the word order the same. The reply begins with hai if the statement is agreed with, and iie if it is disagreed with.

④ Mirā-san wa Amerika-jin desu ka.

Is Mr. Miller an American?

……Hai, Amerika-jin desu.

……Yes, he is [an American].

⑤ Mirā-san wa sensei desu ka.

Is Mr. Miller a teacher?

……Iie, sensei ja arimasen.

……No, he isn't [a teacher].

3) Questions with interrogatives

An interrogative replaces the part of the sentence that states what the speaker wants to ask about. The word order does not change, and ka is added at the end.

⑥ Ano kata wa donata desu ka.

Who's that [person]?

……[Ano kata wa] Mirā-san desu.

……That's Mr. Miller.

4. **N mo**

Mo is used when the same thing applies as was stated previously.

- ⑦ Mirā-san wa kaishain desu. Guputa-san mo kaishain desu.

Mr. Miller is a company employee. Mr Gupta is also a company employee.

5. **N₁ no N₂**

When a noun N₁ modifies a following noun N₂, no is used to connect the two nouns. In Lesson 1, N₁ represents an organisation or some kind of group to which N₂ belongs.

- ⑧ Mirā-san wa IMC no shain desu. Mr. Miller is an IMC employee.

6. **-san**

-san is added to the given name or family name of the listener or a third person to show the speaker's respect to that person. It should never be used with the speaker's own name. -chan is added to small children's names instead of -san to indicate familiarity.

- ⑨ Ano kata wa Mirā-san desu. That's Mr. Miller.

When referring directly to the listener, the word anata (you) is not generally used if the speaker knows the listener's name. The listener's given name or family name followed by -san is usually used.

- ⑩ Suzuki: Mirā-san wa gakusei desu ka. Suzuki: Are you a student, Mr. Miller?
Mirā: Ie, kaishain desu. Miller: No, I work for a company.

[Note] Anata is used to address someone with whom one is very familiar, such as one's husband, wife, romantic partner, etc. Be careful about using it in other situations, as it can sound impolite.